Grammar at a Glance

Nouns

A noun is a word that refers to any person, place, thing, quality or activity.
Examples: *pilot, Kolkata, desk, patience, walk*

Types of nouns

Common: any person or thing of the same group or kind—*woman, owl, building, city*

Proper: exact name—*Ayesha, Johnny, Eiffel Tower, Bhopal*

Concrete: things we can see, hear, smell, taste and/or touch—*grapes, telephone, bottle*

Abstract: ideas, feelings or qualities—*joy, thirst, friendship*

Material: things used to make other things—*wood, iron, metal*

Noun gender

Masculine: boys, men and male animals—*son, uncle, ox*

Feminine: girls, women and female animals—*daughter, aunt, cow*

Common: male and/or female—*children, grandparents, animals*

Neuter: things—*table, bed, lamp*

Verbs

A verb is a word that shows action—physical or mental. (We run./We guessed the answer.) It may also describe the way things are. (They are happy.)

Helping verbs

- do **not** show action.
- come before main verbs.
- form **tenses**, **questions** and **negative sentences**.

Be, *have*, *will* and *do* work as helping verbs.

- We are planting flowers.
- We have planted the seeds.
- Will the birds eat the seeds?
- They did not eat them all.

Irregular verbs

do **not** change form in a regular way

SIMPLE PRESENT	SIMPLE PAST	PAST PARTICIPLE
eat	ate	eaten
drink	drank	drunk
write	wrote	written
draw	drew	drawn
fly	flew	flown
choose	chose	chosen

Pronouns

A pronoun is a word that is used in place of a noun.

Personal		Possessive	Reflexive
I	me	mine	myself
you	you	yours	yourself
he	him	his	himself
she	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	itself
we	us	ours	ourselves

Indefinite pronouns: do not tell us about a specific noun

People	Places	Things
somebody, someone	somewhere	something
everybody, everyone	everywhere	everything
nobody, no one	nowhere	nothing
anybody, anyone	anywhere	anything

Adjectives

Adjectives are words that describe nouns.

many mangoes

Some adjectives tell us about the **quantity** of nouns—how much/how many (*little, few, enough, all, three, whole, many*).

Some adjectives tell us about the **quality** of nouns (*kind, smart, small, young*).

old books

Degrees of adjectives

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
as … as/too … to	*… than*	*the …*
big	bigger	biggest
many	more	most
good	better	best
bad	worse	worst

For **longer** adjectives, we usually use *more* and *most* (*beautiful: more beautiful, most beautiful; colourful: more colourful, most colourful*)

Adverbs

An adverb is a word that describes a verb, an adjective or another adverb.

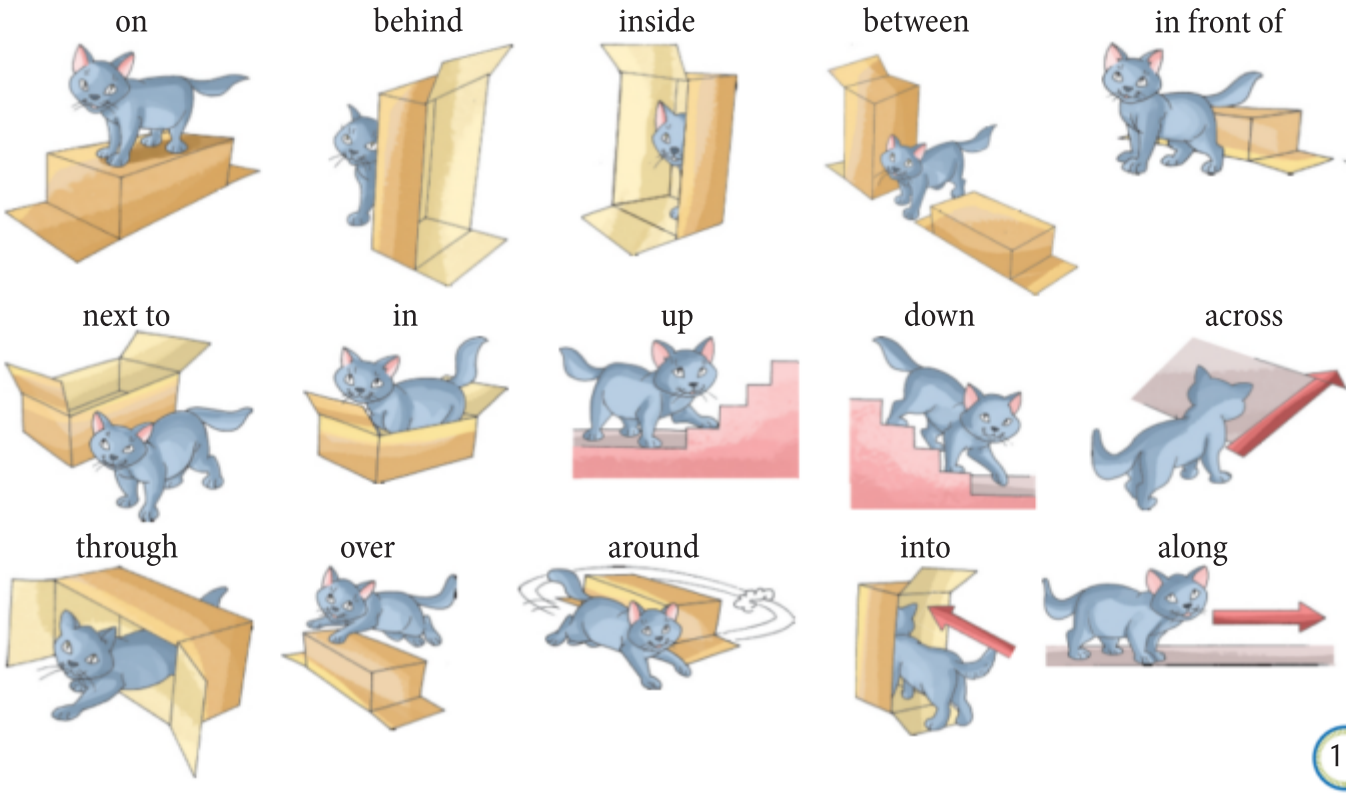
Adverb of manner: how an action is done—*quickly, slowly*

Adverb of time: when an action takes place—*yesterday, later, after, never*

Adverb of degree: extent/intensity of an action—*very, quite, most*

Prepositions

A preposition is a word (or a group of words) that is used before a noun or a pronoun to show place, position and movement.



Conjunctions

A conjunction is used to link words or parts of a sentence.

Types of conjunctions

and—joins similar ideas

I play tennis and chess.

or—joins two alternative ideas

Shall we play tennis or chess?

so—shows reason

It was very foggy so the plane did not take off.

but—joins contrasting ideas

The film is long but interesting.

Conjunction of time—shows **when** (*after, whenever, until, while, when, before*)

Sentences

Subject and predicate

The subject of a sentence tells us *who* or *what* the sentence is about. → Sumit likes reading. ← The predicate of a sentence tells us what the subject *does* or *is*.

Types of sentences

Declarative	statement (tells)		Louisa M. Alcott wrote *Little Women*.
Interrogative	question (asks)		Who wrote *Little Women*?
Imperative	request or command (asks to do or orders)		Please read *Little Women*.
Exclamatory	shows strong feelings		*Little Women* is such a good book!